AURELIUS · HIRING

SALES HIRE INTERVIEW GUIDE

Questions and a scorecard for the commission-based sales role at Aurelius, paid 10% of every client they bring in. Use one copy per candidate.

CANDIDATE | INTERVIEWER | DATE

HOW TO USE THIS

- Ask every candidate the same questions in the same order, so scores can be compared.
- Score each answer from 1 to 5 straight after it: 1 vague or concerning, 3 acceptable, 5 specific and convincing. Write one line of evidence in the notes column.
- Ask for specifics: names, numbers, dates. Move on from any answer that stays general.
- Because pay depends on closing, the hire must sell what Aurelius actually does, honestly. Weigh sections 2 and 4 most heavily.

1 TRACK RECORD

LISTEN FOR numbers, their own mistakes, and "I" rather than "we". Vague answers are a warning sign.

	QUESTION	SCORE 1–5	NOTES
1	What is the largest deal you have closed? Walk me through it from first contact to signature.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
2	What was your sales cycle, average deal size and close rate in your last role? Which of those numbers can I verify?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
3	Tell me about a deal you lost that you should have won. What did you do wrong?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
4	Who in your network could become an Aurelius client in the first 90 days? Name industries and roles, not just "I know people".	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
5	Have you sold marketing, advertising or any other service you cannot touch? What is different from selling a product?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	

2 SELLING AURELIUS

LISTEN FOR whether they promise results we cannot deliver. A salesperson who overpromises creates problems for the delivery team and for our reputation.

	QUESTION	SCORE 1–5	NOTES
6	Pitch Aurelius to me in two minutes, as if I were a founder who has never heard of us.	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
7	A prospect says, "We already have an agency." What do you say?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
8	A prospect asks to see results from similar clients, and we do not have case studies yet. How do you handle that honestly?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
9	Which kind of client should we go after first, and which should we turn down?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
10	A client wants guaranteed leads or sales. How do you respond?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	

3 PROCESS AND DISCIPLINE

	QUESTION	SCORE 1–5	NOTES
11	Describe your weekly routine: how many conversations, meetings and follow-ups, and how do you track them?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
12	How do you qualify a lead? What makes you walk away?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
13	How do you price a deal, and when would you offer a discount?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
14	Our work spans strategy, creative, media and technology. How would you scope a proposal together with the delivery team?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	

4 COMMISSION AND EXPECTATIONS

> **LISTEN FOR** whether they ask sensible questions about the deal themselves. A good salesperson will.

	QUESTION	SCORE 1–5	NOTES
15	How do you feel about earning only a percentage? What would make this worth your time?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
16	How many clients would you need to close in the first six months for this to work for you?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
17	How would you handle a client who signs and then pays late or cancels?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
18	What should happen to your commission if a client you brought leaves after two months?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	

5 JUDGMENT AND FIT

	QUESTION	SCORE 1–5	NOTES
19	A prospect asks for something Aurelius does not offer. What do you do?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
20	If you could not use cold outreach or discounts, how would you win your first client?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
21	What would make you quit after three months?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
22	What do you need from us to succeed?	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	

6 LIVE EXERCISE

RUN IT LIKE THIS

Give the candidate 15 minutes to prepare, then ask for a 5-minute pitch of Aurelius to a made-up prospect, for example a Hyderabad D2C brand whose marketing is weak. Raise two or three objections and watch how they respond.

WHAT TO SCORE	SCORE 1–5	NOTES
Clear, relevant opening that fits the prospect	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Asks questions before pitching	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Handles objections without overpromising	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	
Asks for a clear next step	○ ○ ○ ○ ○	

7 SUMMARY

SECTION SCORES (OUT OF 5)

1 Track record	_____
2 Selling Aurelius	_____
3 Process	_____
4 Commission and expectations	_____
5 Judgment and fit	_____
6 Live exercise	_____

DECISION

HIRE | SECOND ROUND | PASS

REASONS

SETTLE BEFORE THE INTERVIEW (CANDIDATES WILL ASK)

- ☐ **10% of what?** The first-year revenue, only the first contract, or every payment while the client stays? Any cap or time limit?
- ☐ **Paid when?** On signing, or only once the client has paid us?
- ☐ **If a client leaves early or cancels,** is the commission returned?
- ☐ **Employee or independent contractor?** Any base salary or retainer, or purely commission? Commission-only roles are hard to hire for, so expect stronger candidates to ask for a floor.
- ☐ **Who owns the client relationship and contacts** if the salesperson leaves?
- ☐ **Write it down.** Have a lawyer draft the agreement, especially the commission terms and the contractor-versus-employee question, since rules differ by arrangement.